

QCY H3 Pro

Budget headphones with flagship ambitions

Every now and then, you come across a product that makes you pause and recheck the price tag. For me, that moment came when I saw the QCY H3 Pro, a pair of over-ear wireless headphones from the Chinese brand QCY. It boasts features like LDAC, Bluetooth 5.4, adaptive ANC, multipoint connection, 3-mic ENC, 3D spatial audio, 60ms low latency, IPX4 rating, and a claimed 55-hour battery life. All this for Rs 3,999 (launch price Rs 5,999). To put that in perspective, many of these features are what you'd find on something like Sony's WH-1000XM6, which costs almost ten times more.

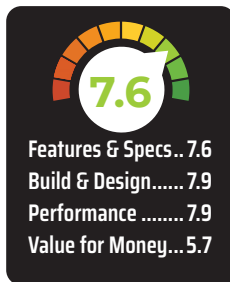
The QCY H3 Pro offers rare features like LDAC, adaptive ANC, multipoint pairing, and long battery life at a budget price. Sound quality is adequate but not standout, and the app feels unpolished. Still, for under Rs 4,000, it's a solid buy for users who value battery endurance, good ANC, and modern features over premium sound or brand polish.

So yes, on paper, the QCY H3 Pro looks like a steal. But what's the catch?

UNBOXING AND DESIGN

QCY H3 Pro comes in 4 different colours, viz., Black, White, and Purple. Our review unit is the white variant, which looks different from the advertised images. It has a hint of baby pink, which is welcoming, and the champagne gold coloured yoke gives a premium feel.

On the earcups, there are some plastic buttons, which are fairly clicky and easily reachable. You get a volume rocker, a power button and an ANC button. Between these, there is a USB-C



port and a 3.5mm headphone jack. Gladly, QCY has bundled both these cables in the box.

The company hasn't cut corners with comfort, either. The headphone chassis is made of plastic and metal and is very light at 231 grams. The metallic clamp is mild. But it wasn't falling off with slight movements. The cushions on the headband and the ear cups are plush. The ear cup curvature could have been bigger, though, for a comfier fit.

The hinges fold, too, which makes it easier to swivel, tuck into a bag and carry it around. This is something often missed in budget headphones. QCY doesn't bundle a case/carry bag, though.

Rest, you get markings for Left and Right sides (on the inner side of the hinge area and the earcups), subtle branding, and even IPX4 water resist-

ance, which can offer protection against sweat, splash, and drizzle.

So, if you commute daily or wear headphones for long periods, the comfort is decent, and the fold-down design helps. But if you wear them outdoors in heavy rain or rough conditions, the build may show wear sooner due to its modest build.

PAIRING AND SOFTWARE

Pairing the QCY H3 Pro is quick and straightforward. Hold the power button for a few seconds, and the headphones enter pairing mode instantly. The Bluetooth range also feels fine. However, the QCY app takes some time to connect to the headphones.

The QCY app is functional, has plenty of features to toggle, but requires account registration to use, and the app interface is less refined. It is clearly a translated version of the Chinese interface, as you'll spot awkward phrasing, cropped text, and inconsistent font alignment throughout.

Furthermore, some features like Bluetooth multipoint work. But there's a caveat: you can't use LDAC and multipoint at the same time. It's either better sound or multi-device convenience, not both. Also, the QCY app wasn't working simultaneously on both devices, in this case, an Android phone and an iPhone.

It may disrupt the user experience, but given the device's price and features, it's more of a simple annoyance rather than a dealbreaker.

AUDIO PERFORMANCE

The first thing I noticed is that the QCY headphones' volume is feeble. I generally listen at 60-80 percent volume in other headphones, but here, I had to amp up the volume for a decently enjoyable experience. Otherwise, everything sounds flat or thinner.

When you turn up the volume and enable the LDAC codec, you get a slight boost in clarity and detail. The sound signature leans bass-forward, with a clear thump, though the rumble and low-end depth fall short. Vocals sound